

# ■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, September 29, 2026

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## TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

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### THE LIST (5 stories)

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#### ■ ***The Ocean Cleanup stopped 463,000 pounds of trash from reaching the Gulf of Honduras in a single catch, using a river barrier in Guatemala to intercept waste before it reaches the Caribbean Sea.***

**The Angle:** A nonprofit just intercepted nearly a quarter-million kilos of garbage in one haul before it could pour into the Caribbean Sea - a rare good-news environmental win with a wild number attached that people love sharing.

- The Ocean Cleanup pulled **463,000 pounds** of trash in a single catch
- The trash was intercepted using a **river barrier in Guatemala**
- The barrier stops waste before it reaches the **Gulf of Honduras** and the **Caribbean Sea**

#### **The Watercooler Stat**

- Try to picture 463,000 pounds of garbage - that's roughly 30 school buses' worth of trash that never made it to the ocean.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.yahoo.com/news/science/articles/ocean-cleanup-stops-463-000-165700715.html>

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#### ■■ ***Kalshi loses again as judges rule prediction markets must obey gambling laws***

**The Angle:** Prediction markets have exploded as the hot new way to bet on everything from elections to sports, and courts keep saying the same thing: this is gambling, and it has to follow gambling law. It's a real threat to a booming industry millions of people have started using.

- Kalshi has now lost **another** court ruling on this exact issue.
- Judges determined **prediction markets** don't get to skip **state gambling laws** just because they're dressed up as financial exchanges.
- It's part of a growing legal pattern chipping away at the industry's argument that these are trading platforms, not betting apps.

#### **The Debate Starter**

- Is trading on 'will this happen' apps actually just gambling with extra steps?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://arstechnica.com/tech-policy/2026/09/another-court-rules-kalshi-sports-bets-arent-swaps-says-states-can-crack-down/>

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#### ■ ***Sask. drone company says no 'special rights' attached to \$10M US investment linked to Trump Jr.***

**The Angle:** Sask. drone company says no 'special rights' attached to \$10M US investment linked to Trump Jr.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/saskatchewan/draganfly-no-special-rights-10m-investment-linked-trump-jr-9.7363003?cmp=rss>

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#### ■ ***Trump says top tech firms have signed accord to 'self-police' AI development***

**The Angle:** The President is touting a voluntary deal where top AI companies promise to police themselves instead of facing hard regulation — critics will instantly ask if that's oversight or just a photo-op.

- **President Trump** says he's signed a voluntary accord with top AI companies
- The deal has AI firms agreeing to **'self-police'** their own development
- No binding government regulation attached — it's a pact, not a law

#### The Debate Starter

- Should we trust AI giants to regulate themselves, or is that like letting the fox guard the henhouse?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/ai-trump-agreement-9.7363125?cmp=rss>

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### ■ Roman Anthony leaves Game 1 against Yankees in possible injury scare: 'Not a good sign'

**The Angle:** Roman Anthony leaves Game 1 against Yankees in possible injury scare: 'Not a good sign'

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/09/29/sports/roman-anthony-leaves-game-1-of-wild-card-series-against-yankees-with-apparent-injury/>

Backup options:

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### ■ 'Sir, we are sorry:' Trump expects Canada to cave as import ban takes effect. Follow for live updates.

**The Angle:** 'Sir, we are sorry:' Trump expects Canada to cave as import ban takes effect. Follow for live updates.

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: [https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi\\_gFBVV95cUxNNVZvYmxMSmRhdkU1cmZ3NV9Nam1ucjVXdI9FTIdnYjgzUDJITHhMSmJlcZJKSznqVU9WY0ZFNE4yaWJ2MUQzajdtR2NCWGJISnVCa3pYWjFLUHVGRVJLMnp4b05QZTUtY083NnpBdmRJT0x1TEIKSkptN1h0d1NibXUzdVVZaVFtb3pnQ29TaEtoWWxYbDZlUlduT0hWV3RHbVhxb25iWjZNTS13c0VMVC0ydTJWMGJvX25XYWJmVFpOMFYtY0xZbloxWHhGaDJTb194ekVJVkxOR1BJWXltTjlkMjVfZUN2YzE0Z3lPdjbQczJxYllrYUZWelBLQQ?oc=5](https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi_gFBVV95cUxNNVZvYmxMSmRhdkU1cmZ3NV9Nam1ucjVXdI9FTIdnYjgzUDJITHhMSmJlcZJKSznqVU9WY0ZFNE4yaWJ2MUQzajdtR2NCWGJISnVCa3pYWjFLUHVGRVJLMnp4b05QZTUtY083NnpBdmRJT0x1TEIKSkptN1h0d1NibXUzdVVZaVFtb3pnQ29TaEtoWWxYbDZlUlduT0hWV3RHbVhxb25iWjZNTS13c0VMVC0ydTJWMGJvX25XYWJmVFpOMFYtY0xZbloxWHhGaDJTb194ekVJVkxOR1BJWXltTjlkMjVfZUN2YzE0Z3lPdjbQczJxYllrYUZWelBLQQ?oc=5)

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## CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

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### ■ Carney suggests immigration increase is on the horizon in New York Times interview

**The Angle:** After years of Ottawa slamming the brakes on immigration numbers, the PM just told the New York Times more people could be on the way in - a total 180 that's going to reignite the whole housing-and-jobs debate.

- **Mark Carney** floated the idea of raising immigration levels in a sit-down with **The New York Times**
- Comes after his government spent the last stretch dialing immigration targets \*down\*, not up
- No hard numbers or timeline confirmed yet - just Carney signaling a shift in direction

#### The Debate Starter

- Is Canada ready to reverse course on immigration, or did the last round of cuts happen for a reason?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.ctvnews.ca/politics/article/carney-suggests-immigration-increase-is-on-the-horizon-in-new-york-times-interview/>

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### ■ In New York Times interview, PM Carney suggests immigration increase is on the horizon

**The Angle:** In New York Times interview, PM Carney suggests immigration increase is on the horizon

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiWAFBV95cUxOM05EaVRXdI9DRW1XOE1UZXF4YXppd2tyYmxJVE12T0Z2cjNGSnJMYTU5MzFtYjhhQkVXbzNUSWdMc0l1N1ZnSnk4ckF6emxPbE5MMktLWWctdzduVWppcmVOVXF2NzY1QU1mbnIMZ2o2NHVoMjdaRnpqW>

## ■ **Netanyahu meets Emirati leader in a secret weekend trip to Abu Dhabi, and other Mideast developments - AP News**

**The Angle:** Netanyahu meets Emirati leader in a secret weekend trip to Abu Dhabi, and other Mideast developments - AP News

Associated Press (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://apnews.com/article/israel-iran-uae-netanyahu-yemen-september-28-2026-854377716258982535c7b2cd3a7d0fe0>

Backup options:

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## ■ **Struggling Tim Hortons franchisee cites limits to foreign workers: report**

**The Angle:** It's the classic double-double debate — a franchisee going public on limits to hiring foreign workers taps right into the national conversation about labor shortages, immigration policy, and whether small business owners are getting squeezed.

### **The Debate Starter**

- Should Ottawa loosen foreign worker caps for struggling small businesses, or is that a band-aid on a bigger wage problem?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/news/national/struggling-tim-hortons-franchisee-foreign-workers>

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## ■ **Conservative MP Scott Aitchison expected to resign this fall: sources**

**The Angle:** Conservative MP Scott Aitchison expected to resign this fall: sources

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/scott-aitchison-expected-to-resign-9.7363151?cmp=rss>

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## ■ **Polo makes 2nd landfall on Mexico's Pacific coast**

**The Angle:** A hurricane making a rare second landfall is the kind of freak-weather story that grabs attention, especially with Baja California already soaked before round two hit the mainland coast.

- Hurricane Polo made its **second landfall** on Mexico's northwestern Pacific coast on **Tuesday**
- It had already drenched the southern **Baja California peninsula** before this latest hit

### **The Weather Watch**

- Two landfalls from one storm - anyone got Baja travel plans they're now nervously refreshing the forecast for?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/hurricane-polo-second-landfall-mexico-9.7362838?cmp=rss>

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## ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

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## ■ **'Dancing With the Stars' sends another couple home in shocking 'Yacht Rock Night' elimination**

**The Angle:** It's the season's latest gut-punch elimination, and Yacht Rock Night's cheesy-fun theme made the surprise boot hit even harder — perfect fodder for hosts to debate whether America's voting got it wrong again.

- Another celebrity and their pro partner were eliminated **Tuesday night**
- The elimination came on **'Yacht Rock Night'**, a themed competition episode
- Fans and the hosts are calling it a **'shocking'** result

### The Debate Starter

- Was this the right couple to send home, or did America's votes get it wrong again?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://pagesix.com/2026/09/29/entertainment/taylor-hanson-eliminated-from-dancing-with-the-stars-during-yacht-rock-night/>

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### ■ **Deeply embarrassing sequence. Eric Schmitt accuses Jack Smith of traveling to Atlanta to attend an Atlanta Hawks game and collude with Fani Willis, only to get the basic facts completely wrong. Smith was actually in Maryland attending a Hawkeyes game and never met Willis**

*The Angle:* A senator tried to drop a bombshell accusation and instead delivered a masterclass in not fact-checking yourself — mixing up an NBA team with a college football team in the process. It's the kind of self-own that writes its own punchline.

- **Sen. Eric Schmitt** accused **Jack Smith** of flying to Atlanta to catch a **Hawks** game as cover to secretly meet **Fani Willis**
- Only problem: **Smith** was actually in **Maryland** watching the **Hawkeyes** — as in Iowa's college team, not Atlanta's NBA team
- The two teams share basically nothing but a similar name
- No evidence **Smith** and **Willis** ever met at all

### The Gotcha That Backfired

- Nothing sinks a scandal claim faster than not knowing the difference between an NBA team and a Big Ten team.

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://v.redd.it/rceuob3zbish1>

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### ■ **Tom Cruise is fantastic in Digger. You might hate it**

*The Angle:* A new Alejandro G. Iñárritu climate drama has critics split: Tom Cruise is getting raves for the performance, but reviewers are calling out the film itself for lecturing audiences on climate doom while cashing in on that same doom for entertainment.

- **Tom Cruise** stars in "**Digger**," directed by **Alejandro G. Iñárritu**
- **CBC** calls it a "climate morality tale" — but not necessarily a compliment
- The critique: the movie uses "high-minded entertainment" to joke about "our impending doom" the same way society ignored the real crisis
- Reviewer's verdict on Cruise: fantastic performance — but "you might hate it"

### The Debate Starter

- Can a movie preach about the climate crisis while entertaining you with it — or is that exactly the problem?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/digger-review-9.7362251?cmp=rss>

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### ■ **American taps small Sask. business to solve international photo mystery**

*The Angle:* American taps small Sask. business to solve international photo mystery

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/saskatchewan/american-photographer-saskatchewan-company-solve-mystery-9.7361414?cmp=rss>

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Backup options:

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### ■ **Hereos, zeros from Yankees' Game 1 rout of Red Sox: Austin Wells did it all**

*The Angle:* A 9-0 wild-card blowout with a breakout performance is easy, fun sports talk for a rivalry that always gets people fired up.

- Yankees demolished the Red Sox 9-0 in Game 1 of the wild-card series
- Catcher Austin Wells was the story of the night, described as a guy who "did it all"
- Classic Yankees-Red Sox playoff rivalry adds extra juice to a lopsided win

#### The Debate Starter

- Is this Red Sox team already cooked, or is one bad night not worth panicking over?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/09/29/sports/hereos-zeros-from-yankees-game-1-rout-of-red-sox-austin-wells-did-it-all/>

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### ■ Cam Schlittler & Ben Rice Dominate the Red Sox 9-0 Game 1 Postgame LIVE | Pinstripe Post

**The Angle:** Yankees-Red Sox in a winner-take-all-style playoff series is appointment viewing for the whole Northeast, and a 9-0 Game 1 blowout instantly changes the temperature heading into Game 2.

- Yankees thumped the Red Sox 9-0 in Game 1 of the AL Wild Card series
- Cam Schlittler and Ben Rice were the standout performers driving the win
- It's being billed as a historic Yankees-Red Sox Wild Card matchup

#### The Rivalry Reaction

- Red Sox fans, be honest - after a 9-0 Game 1, is this series already over?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/video/cam-schlittler-ben-rice-dominate-the-red-sox-9-0-game-1-postgame-live-pinstripe-post/>

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### ■ Why 'Lioness' Star Zoe Saldña "Can't Imagine" Joining Another Taylor Sheridan Show - The Hollywood Reporter

**The Angle:** Why 'Lioness' Star Zoe Saldña "Can't Imagine" Joining Another Taylor Sheridan Show - The Hollywood Reporter

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/tv/tv-news/lioness-zoe-saldana-cant-join-another-taylor-sheridan-show-1236714032/>

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## TRENDING TODAY

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### ■ Alix Earle makes shocking revelation that she's 'never read a book': 'Maybe Dr. Seuss?'

**The Angle:** The internet's favorite influencer just casually confessed she's never finished a book in her life, and the backlash online is instant - it's the kind of confession that splits a room right down the middle between 'who cares' and 'come on.'

- Alix Earle revealed she's 'never read a book'
- When pressed for an example, her best guess was 'Maybe Dr. Seuss?'
- The confession sparked backlash from critics online

#### The Debate Starter

- Be honest - what's the last book YOU actually finished cover to cover?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://pagesix.com/2026/09/29/celebrity-news/alix-earle-makes-shocking-revelation-that-shes-never-read-a-book/>

Backup options:

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### ■ White Sox get blessing from Pope Leo before MLB playoffs — then go dominate Astros

**The Angle:** Pope Leo XIV, a Chicago guy himself, sent the White Sox a good-luck letter right before their playoff game against Houston — and they went out and won. It's the kind of sports-meets-faith coincidence that's tailor-made for a fun morning-show tangent.

- **Pope Leo XIV** sent a letter of support to the **White Sox** ahead of their playoff matchup.
- The team shared the Pope's letter on social media just hours before first pitch.
- **Chicago** beat the **Astros 6-3** at **Daikin Park** on Tuesday.
- Pope Leo XIV is widely known as a lifelong **White Sox fan** from the Chicago area.

#### The Debate Starter

- Divine intervention or just a good lineup — does a papal blessing actually juice a team's mojo?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/09/29/sports/white-sox-get-blessing-from-pope-leo-before-mlb-playoffs-then-go-dominate-astros/>

### ■ ■ 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day' Re-Release in the Works With New Footage - Variety

**The Angle:** A new 'Spider-Man' movie getting a mystery re-release before it's even out is the kind of hype move that gets fans (and non-fans) speculating online for weeks.

- **Variety** confirms '**Spider-Man: Brand New Day**' is getting a re-release featuring **new footage**
- Studio is keeping details on the new scenes **under wraps**
- No **release date** has been announced yet for the re-release

#### The Speculation Starter

- What do you think they're hiding in that new footage - a twist, a cameo, or just a marketing tease?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://variety.com/2026/film/news/spider-man-brand-new-day-re-release-new-footage-tom-holland-1236877741/>

## LIFESTYLE CHAT

### ■ Creatine alone boosted lean muscle and strength, study finds

**The Angle:** Creatine alone boosted lean muscle and strength, study finds

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.newsnationnow.com/health/creatine-alone-boosted-muscle-strength/>

Backup options:

### ■ Victoria's Secret Announces Lineup of All-Women Musical Performers for 2026 Fashion Show - People.com

**The Angle:** The Victoria's Secret runway show is one of the year's biggest fashion-meets-pop-culture events, and going all-women for the performers is the kind of lineup choice that gets fans immediately speculating who's on the bill.

- **Victoria's Secret** has confirmed its **2026 Fashion Show** will feature an all-women musical lineup
- Full performer names haven't been detailed yet in what we've got - watch for the reveal

#### The Guessing Game

- Who's your dream pick to perform at the VS show - callers, drop your bets now before the names drop.

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMifkFVX3lxTE1jeHNYaU1LTlIINIEtc1duV01GckltQkZOV2JzTkFpVXJFcmpESUhoMkJ3TnlYQ3JSNWJEWW9nY0dWR1ZIRk9VWEI4NDBNOHJPV3JMRXBtcDhWbGY1ZkxjdU1pQXlpQWhBNTB0VDh2UFJrYlpiLUtvMTRMYWc3ZW?oc=5>

**■ Your car's data privacy problems are worse than you think / A team of researchers tested 21 vehicles and found that all of them transmitted data to a third-party domain. And over half were pinging advertising companies.**

**The Angle:** *Your car's data privacy problems are worse than you think / A team of researchers tested 21 vehicles and found that all of them transmitted data to a third-party domain. And over half were pinging advertising companies.*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.theverge.com/transportation/1001463/car-data-privacy-northeastern-study-honda-gm-ford>

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## CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

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■ **After 6,000 years, European bison are back in Britain. A new herd is being reintroduced to 5,000 acres of protected land, where the giant mammals will help restore natural habitats and create new homes for other wildlife.**

**The Angle:** *Europe's biggest land mammal is making a comeback on British soil for the first time since the Bronze Age - it's the kind of pure, feel-good nature story that's perfect to send the audience off on.*

- **European bison** are being reintroduced to Britain for the first time in **6,000 years**
- The new herd is settling into **5,000 acres** of protected land
- The giant grazers are expected to help restore natural habitats and create new homes for other wildlife

### The Happy Ending

- Sometimes the biggest news is just something ancient getting a second chance.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nz.news.yahoo.com/bison-back-britain-6-000-231449746.html>

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Backup options:

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■■ **At least 20 planned school shootings have been stopped since 2018 after warning signs were reported through Sandy Hook Promise prevention programs. The latest was in Arkansas, where an anonymous tip led to an intervention before anyone was hurt**

**The Angle:** *This is the good-news flip side of a topic that usually terrifies parents - a tip line actually works, and the most recent save just happened in Arkansas with zero people hurt.*

- **Sandy Hook Promise's** prevention programs have helped stop at least **20 planned school shootings** since **2018**
- The most recent intervention happened in **Arkansas**
- It started with an **anonymous tip** flagging warning signs before anyone was harmed
- No injuries, no headlines that day - just a threat caught and handled quietly

### The Feel-Good Takeaway

- One anonymous tip in Arkansas is the reason today's kicker isn't a tragedy - that's the story worth sending listeners home with.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.sandyhookpromise.org/news/press-releases/prevention-programs-have-helped-stop-20-school-shootings-since-2018/>

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**FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 2/5 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)**

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

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## ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

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### ■ ■ An 11-year-old from Harrow has become the youngest woman grandmaster in chess history

**The Angle:** A kid who's barely out of elementary school just made chess history, and it's the kind of pure, no-catch feel-good story that's perfect to send listeners off on a high note.

- An 11-year-old girl from Harrow, England has officially become the **youngest woman grandmaster in chess history**.
- Grandmaster is the highest title in chess — most players never reach it in a lifetime, let alone before puberty.

#### The Humble-Brag Check

- Ask listeners: what record could an 11-year-old in YOUR house possibly hold right now?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://sheets.works/story/keep-making-history?r=stories>

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### ■ ■ New Mexico has banned new uranium mining on more than 13 million acres of state trust lands and ordered its Land Office to prioritise cleaning up abandoned uranium sites left by decades of mining. At least 50 of those legacy sites are on state trust land.

**The Angle:** This isn't just a local land rule — New Mexico is taking a hard stance on a decades-old environmental mess, banning future uranium mining and forcing cleanup of old radioactive sites that have lingered for generations.

- New Mexico banned new uranium mining across more than **13 million acres** of state trust land.
- The state's Land Office has been ordered to prioritize cleaning up abandoned uranium sites.
- At least **50** legacy uranium sites sit on state trust land, left over from decades of past mining.

#### The Debate Starter

- Is this a win for the environment, or a state closing the door on a future energy source right when uranium demand is climbing again?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://sourcennm.com/2026/09/04/new-mexico-land-commissioner-announces-uranium-mining-ban-on-state-trust-lands/>

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### ■ Arkansas governor feuds with conservatives over welfare ad portraying white man gaming

**The Angle:** A state welfare campaign ad starring a character named 'Brad' was meant to promote work requirements — instead it's got conservatives turning on the governor over how the ad frames who 'games' the system. It's the rare culture-war dust-up where the friendly fire is coming from inside the house.

- The ad centers on a character named **Brad**, framed as someone gaming the welfare system.
- Backlash is coming from **conservative critics**, not the usual opposition — an intra-party feud.
- The governor is defending the ad campaign as pushback mounts over its optics.

#### The Debate Starter

- When your own side turns on your ad campaign, did you actually mess up — or did you just make people uncomfortable with the truth?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://thenationaldesk.com/news/americas-news-now/arkansas-gov-sarah-huckabee-sanders-feuds-with-conservatives-over-welfare-ad-sarah-huckabee-sanders-matt-walsh>

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## FRANCHISE BANK

### WHAT THE FRIDAY: 5 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: 'Wtf come on'" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-22)
- "VMAs 2026 best and worst moments: Dolly Parton tributes, Madonna's bizarre speeches" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Hundreds of lefties link arms for bizarre 'hands across the sand' protest against California oil drilling" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-28)

### THROWBACK THURSDAY: 20 banked (+15 each when found)

- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live's 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "'Practical Magic 2' Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of 'Sunday in the Park With George' has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits <https://t.co/cPQ2IlvYqI>" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here's Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary 'Neo City: The Redline' Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-22)
- "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-22)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary 'Neo City: The Redline' Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-23)
- "'The Visit' at Pasadena Playhouse Review: The '50s Absurdist Comedy Is Too Smug in Its Peak-Bleak View of Venal Humanity, but Jefferson Mays and Melinda Page Hamilton Are Worth the Visit" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-23)
- "Neil Patrick Harris to Star in 'Damn Yankees' Broadway Revival" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris and Julianne Hough to Lead First Broadway Revival of Damn Yankees in Over 30 Years - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris Will Lead Damn Yankees Broadway Revival Spring 2027 - Playbill" (Playbill.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-09-28)
- "Kawhi Leonard has fun with Ka'Wine & Dine revival at Raptors media day: 'I can't eat as much'" (Toronto Star (via Google News), banked 2026-09-29)
- "Less than two weeks shy of the one-year anniversary of 'The Life of a Showgirl,' Taylor Swift surprised fans by releasing four bonus tracks" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-29)

### Newly banked this run:

- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Less than two weeks shy of the one-year anniversary of 'The Life of a Showgirl,' Taylor Swift surprised fans by releasing four bonus tracks"

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### SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/entertainment (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- studyfinds.com (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 3 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-30 02:55 PM